ENG 205 – Advanced Composition Writing I

Course Outline

1. Concept of writing
2 – What is writing?
3 – Why do we write?
4 Types of compositions
-> Essays -> Speeches
-> Letters -> Memos -> Academic writing
-> ~~Learning composition~~ / Lengthy Compositions
-> Short stories / stories
5. The mechanics of writing
- Punctuations
- Concord
- Paragraphying
- Sentence types

Papirus - The first paper back then.

Advanced Composition Writing I

~~1. The conc~~ What is Writing?

Writing is the act lart of communicating our thought and ideas through graphics symbols. (Graphics - To draw). There are all kinds of writing systems and writing is also as old as man. E.g. In the days of Moses.

i. ~~Hie~~ Hieroglyphic writing (Ancient writing)
ii. Uniform
iii. Arabic system of writing (From right to left)
iv. Roman system (From left to right).
v. Western system (From left to right.)
vi. Chinese system
vii. Roman numeral

Why do we Write?

1. The primary reason we write is to express our thoughts and ideas especially with someone or people that are not with us.
2. As students we write notes and exams.
3. For fun

Types of Compositions / Writing

1. Essays
2. Speeches
3. Letters
4. Memos
5. Academic writing.

Letters

A letter is a piece of ~~wr~~ composition written by someone called the sender and meant to be read by another called the receiver.
(sender - writer; receiver - addressee).

Types of Letters

There are two types of letter
1. Informal letter
2. Formal letter

Informal letter is written to one with whom the writer is familiar with. They include family members, friends, ~~and~~ acquaintances, colleagues, and coursemates.

Structure of an Informal Letter.

1. One address
2. Date
3. Telephone number, email address.
4. Salutation
5. Body
6. Closure

The tone is less formal, relaxed (structure too).
Language is simple and easy to understand (everyday words), abbr., slangs and colloquials can be used.

No limited length.

- Formal letter is a literary composition/an official composition written by the sender to another person. The sender can be an individual or a corporate body.

The receiver can also be an individual or a corporate body. A formal letter can be written by a corporate body to another corporate body/or an individual.

~~Differences Between Memo and Letter Writing~~

Punctuation

- Punctuation are marks used to convey meanings (either written sentences or spoken sentences). When wrongly used, the wrong message is communicated. Some punctuation marks are used to ~~achieve~~ enhance grammaticality. For example:

- Capitalisation: This indicates

1. The first letter in a sentence.

2. Also used for proper nouns, places, people, titles, etc.
3. It is also used for emphasis.

- Comma → This is the most widely used punctuation mark, which is used to convey meaning, representing a slight pause in speech. To indicate a break in the flow of thoughts. The comma also can aid grammaticality. It should be noted that no two linguists often agree on the position of a comma, making it mostly disputed especially when performing grammaticality. Some argued that many commas tend to slow down the flow of reading.

Examples:
- A woman, without her man, is incomplete.
- A woman, without her, man is incomplete.

- Full stop (.)
1. Indicating end of a sentence
2. To show abbreviation.

Paragraphing / The Paragraph

A paragraph is a group of sentences with a common/single theme.

Features of a Paragraph

- Unity or cohesion
- Coherence
- Usually having a topic sentence and a topic sentence is the central idea that unites a paragraph. The topic sentence can be located in any part of the paragraph.

Example

The Badagri slave museum is situated in a place known as the point of no return. This was the jetty where slaves were exported to other countries. The museum occupies about ten hectares of land. The land was acquired by the Nigerian government. The museum was built to serve as a memorial to the millions of Nigerians that were exported as slaves.

The museum is home to artifacts related to slave trade such as: the hand chain, the leg shackles, gin (ogogoro), etc.

How to Achieve Cohesion

- The use of conjunction

- The use of repetition.
- Reiteration

How to Achieve Coherence

By coherence, we mean the flow of ideas in a text (logical) that gives it meaning. For a text to be meaningful, all sentences must flow into each other.

- Lasu is expensive

- Donald Trump is the President of America. } Disconnected lines.
- The television is on.

Concord

Another word for concord is agreement. Concord is the agreement between the different parts of a sentence.

1. Grammatical concord
2. Concord of proximity
3. Notational concord

1. Grammatical Concord

A subject and its verb must agree in tense and in number

<Something is meant to be here> If the subject is singular, the verb must be singular and vice versa.

Concord of Proximity

Proximity means nearness. In other words, the number of the verb is determined by the number of the subject closest to it. E.g

Either the driver or his brakes are at fault.

Either his brakes or the driver is at fault.